

WEEK 5 · FINOPS

Your AWS cost-control checklist.

Five checks to review your own cloud cost. The useful takeaway, given away free.

INSIDE

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Five checks to review your own AWS cost each month, with the tools to use, how to tell it is working and a printable checklist.

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HOW TO USE IT

Five checks. Every month.

Run this checklist once a month with the people who own the spend. Each check takes minutes in the AWS console. The value comes from doing it every time, not from doing it perfectly once.

Bring the owners

Invite the people who can act: an engineer, someone from finance and each budget owner.

Work in order

The checks build on each other. Ownership first makes everything after it faster.

End with actions

Leave with a short list of actions, an owner for each and next month's date.

01

PART 01

The five checks.

In order, every month, with the people who own the spend.

01	Give every resource an owner
02	Switch off what is idle
03	Clear out old storage
04	Match commitments to usage
05	Set alerts, then review

01



Give every resource an owner

Spend without an owner is spend nobody will question.

DO THIS

Tag by team, project and environment, then switch on cost allocation tags.

USING

AWS Cost Allocation Tags and Tag Editor.

IT IS WORKING WHEN

You can group the whole bill by owner, with little left untagged.

COMMON SNAG

Tags applied by hand drift. Enforce them with policy where you can.



OWNER

Platform team

Bring this to the monthly review, with a date for each action.

02



Switch off what is idle

Pay for what you use, not for what is left running.

DO THIS

Schedule non-production to stop out of hours, and rightsize from real utilisation.

USING

Instance Scheduler and AWS Compute Optimizer.

IT IS WORKING WHEN

Non-production is quiet at night and weekends, and sizes match real use.

COMMON SNAG

Teams fear breaking things. Start with clearly non-critical systems.



OWNER

Engineering leads

Bring this to the monthly review, with a date for each action.

03



Clear out old storage

What nobody deletes, everyone pays for.

DO THIS

Delete unattached volumes and stale snapshots, and add lifecycle rules to buckets.

USING

EBS and snapshot views, S3 lifecycle policies and S3 Storage Lens.

IT IS WORKING WHEN

Storage grows with the business, not with time.

COMMON SNAG

Uncertainty about what is safe to delete. Agree a retention rule first.



OWNER

Infrastructure team

Bring this to the monthly review, with a date for each action.

04

Match commitments to usage

Commit to what is steady. Stay flexible on the rest.

DO THIS

Check coverage and utilisation before you buy or renew anything.

USING

Savings Plans and Reserved Instance coverage and utilisation reports.

IT IS WORKING WHEN

Steady workloads are covered and commitments are fully used.

COMMON SNAG

Buying on last year's estate. Review after big changes.

OWNER

Finance with engineering

Bring this to the monthly review, with a date for each action.

05



Set alerts, then review

Catch surprises between reviews, not on the invoice.

DO THIS

Put budgets and anomaly alerts in place, and review them with each owner.

USING

AWS Budgets and AWS Cost Anomaly Detection.

IT IS WORKING WHEN

Owners hear about spikes within days, and act on them.

COMMON SNAG

Alerts sent to a shared inbox nobody reads. Route them to owners.



OWNER

FinOps lead

Bring this to the monthly review, with a date for each action.

MONTHLY REVIEW

A thirty-minute agenda

Keep it short, keep it regular and always end with owned actions.

01 What changed

Review the month's movement by service and by owner.

02 Anomalies

Walk through any alerts and confirm each was explained or fixed.

03 Last month's actions

Close what is done. Re-date what is not, with a reason.

04 The five checks

Run the checklist and note anything you could not tick.

05 New actions

One owner and one date for each, then book next month.

REMEMBER

Consistency beats depth. A short review every month does more than a deep one every year.

PRINTABLE CHECKLIST

This month's review

Print this page or copy it into your meeting notes. Tick each check, and note the owner for anything left open.

- [ ] **Every resource has an owner**
  Owner for gaps: _____

- [ ] **Idle resources switched off or rightsized**
  Owner for gaps: _____

- [ ] **Old storage cleared**
  Owner for gaps: _____

- [ ] **Commitments match usage**
  Owner for gaps: _____

- [ ] **Budgets and anomaly alerts reviewed**
  Owner for gaps: _____

- [ ] **Actions agreed and next review booked**
  Date: _____

TRANSPUTEC

Five checks. Every month.

Want help running the first one? We can review your AWS cost with you and leave the habit in place.

Ask for a cost review

transputec.com

COMING IN FEBRUARY

Our cost-control webinar brings the whole series together.